

Website Handoff Notes

The technical facts and decisions behind handing off **nme.fas.harvard.edu**. Companion to the Maintenance Guide.

Repository: github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website Prepared July 2026

Handoff

Site facts (the ground truth)

- **Type:** static site — plain HTML/CSS/JS. No build step, no framework, no server. This is deliberate: it's why a non-technical PI can maintain it.
- **Repository:** github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website (Chris's personal account).
- **Hosting:** GitHub Pages, served from the `main` branch, repository root.
- **Live URL:** nme.fas.harvard.edu, set by the `CNAME` file plus a Harvard FAS DNS record.
- **Deploy:** push to `main` → GitHub Pages rebuilds automatically (~1 min). No manual publish step.

Handoff

The one architectural gotcha

`js/main.js` is the shared brain of the site. It injects the **nav and footer** into every page, and also holds the **search index** (hand-maintained), the **slideshow captions**, and the research-tab / load-more behavior.

! Nav, footer, and search are centralized here — not per-page. Any editor (human or AI) needs to know this. It's documented in `CLAUDE.md`, which Claude Code loads automatically.

Handoff

Access — chosen approach

- ◆ **Decision: add Rachel as an Admin.** The repo stays on Chris's account; Rachel gets full control without touching hosting or DNS.

On `github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website` → **Settings** → **Collaborators and teams** → **Add people** → add Rachel with the **Admin** role. Add one backup lab member as Admin too, so access never rests on a single person.

A full ownership transfer was considered and declined — it would have required a coordinated DNS change with Harvard FAS. Revisit only if Chris's account is ever closed. The Claude/Anthropic account Rachel uses for Claude Code is separate from GitHub and should be her own.

Handoff

Handoff checklist

- ☐ Add Rachel (+ one backup) as **Admin** collaborators on the repo.
- ☐ Confirm GitHub Pages is green (Settings → Pages; custom domain reads `nme.fas.harvard.edu`, HTTPS enforced).
- ☐ Clone the repo fresh onto Rachel's / the lab machine.
- ☐ Install Claude Code there; sign in with a lab-owned Claude account; confirm `c laude` launches in the repo folder.
- ☐ Do one **live test edit together** end-to-end (add a dummy news item, publish, see it, then remove it). The most valuable part of the handoff.
- ☐ Record the Harvard FAS / HEB IT contact for any future DNS issues.

Reference docs in the repo

FILE	PURPOSE
README.md	Front door — points to the guides
Maintenance-Guide.pdf	Non-technical maintenance guide (for Rachel)
CLAUDE.md	Auto-loaded project guide for AI assistants
Handoff-Notes.pdf	This document

What Rachel can do alone: everything in the maintenance guide (all reversible via git history). What should involve a technical helper: changing the domain / CNAME , restructuring layout or CSS, or touching GitHub Pages / DNS settings.